

Carlos Mendes

Executive Chef

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Instagram LinkedIn

Executive chef specializing in modern Portuguese cuisine with Mediterranean influences. Fifteen years leading brigades in Michelin-starred kitchens and boutique hotel restaurants.

EXPERIENCE

Executive Chef

Mar 2019 – Present

Quinta do Atlântico · Viana do Castelo, Portugal

Lead kitchen brigade of 14; responsible for menu, suppliers, food cost, and HACCP compliance.

- Earned first Michelin star in 2023; retained in 2024 and 2025.
- Reduced food waste 35% through root-to-leaf programme and compost partnership.
- Curated wine pairing programme with 120-label cellar focusing on Douro and Vinho Verde.

Sous Chef

Jun 2014 – Feb 2019

Restaurante Maré Alta · Lisbon, Portugal

Second-in-command; ran hot line during service and managed fish butchery.

- Developed signature octopus confit dish featured in national food press.
- Trained 8 commis chefs through Escola de Hotelaria partnership.

Chef de Partie – Garde Manger

2011 – May 2014

Hotel InterContinental Porto · Porto, Portugal

Managed cold kitchen, charcuterie, and banquet plating for events up to 300 guests.

- Standardized mise en place reducing banquet setup time 20%.
- Introduced local cheese board programme sourcing from Minho producers.

VOLUNTEER

Volunteer Chef

Jun 2020 – Present

Refettorio Porto

Prepare weekly meals from surplus ingredients for community dining programme.

- Served 4,000+ meals since programme launch.
- Mentored culinary students on zero-waste cooking techniques.

EDUCATION

Escola de Hotelaria e Turismo do Porto

Sep 2009 – Jun 2011

Professional Certificate, Culinary Arts · Distinction

- Classic French Techniques
- Pastry Fundamentals
- Food Safety and HACCP

- Restaurant Service Integration

PROJECTS

Chef's Table Documentary Series

Mar 2024 – Sep 2024

Quinta do Atlântico · presentation · Host, Creative director

Six-episode web series following suppliers from boat to plate along the Minho coast.

Documentary, Food media, Sustainability

- 500k views on YouTube in first season.
- Featured on RTP2 culinary programme.

Pop-up Collaboration – Lisbon Wine Week

May 2025 – May 2025

Lisbon Wine Week · volunteering · Executive chef, Menu designer

Five-course collaborative dinner with three Portuguese winemakers.

Pop-up, Wine pairing, Charity

- Sold out 120 seats in 48 hours.
- Raised €8,000 for Refettorio Porto.

SKILLS

Cuisine

Master — Modern Portuguese, Seafood, Charcuterie, Fermentation, Live fire

Kitchen Management

Master — Brigade leadership, Food costing, Menu engineering, Supplier relations

Pastry

Competent — Petit fours, Ice creams, Plated desserts

AWARDS

Michelin Star – Quinta do Atlântico

Nov 2023

Michelin Guide Portugal

One star: High quality cooking, worth a stop.

Chef of the Year – Norte Region

May 2024

Revista de Vinhos

Voted best emerging chef in Northern Portugal by panel of critics and sommeliers.

CERTIFICATES

HACCP Level 3 – Food Safety Management

Jan 2024

ASAE Portugal

WSET Level 2 Award in Wines

Sep 2022

Wine & Spirit Education Trust

ServSafe Manager Certification

2018

National Restaurant Association

PUBLICATIONS

Atlantic Ingredients: A Chef's Guide to Minho Produce

Jan 2025

Assírio & Alvim

200-page cookbook and supplier guide celebrating coastal and mountain ingredients of northern Portugal.

LANGUAGES

Portuguese — Native

Spanish — Fluent

English — Professional

French — Basic

INTERESTS

Foraging

Wild mushrooms, Coastal herbs, Seasonal menus

Fado Music

Live performance, Portuguese guitar, Cultural heritage

REFERENCES

Ana Ribeiro, General Manager

Carlos transformed our restaurant into a destination. His leadership, creativity, and respect for local producers define everything we serve.